

Situational Writing Blueprint

Paper 1, Section B (30 marks)

A Step-by-Step Framework for Exam Success

Time allocation:	30–35 minutes (out of 1 hour 50 minutes for Paper 1)
Word count:	250–350 words (syllabus requirement); aim for 300–320 words
Marks:	30 marks (Task Fulfilment: 10 Language: 20)
Process:	RAWCP: Read and analyse → Arrange your plan → Write → Check tone → Proofread

** Time allocation is a recommended guideline, not an official SEAB requirement. The syllabus specifies only the total Paper 1 duration of 1 hour 50 minutes.*

Throughout this document, NOTE annotations (in italics) identify content that reflects widely accepted teaching conventions in Singapore but is not stated in the official SEAB 1184 syllabus. All unmarked content is verified against the syllabus.

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Chapter 1 TL;DR — Too Long, Didn't Read?

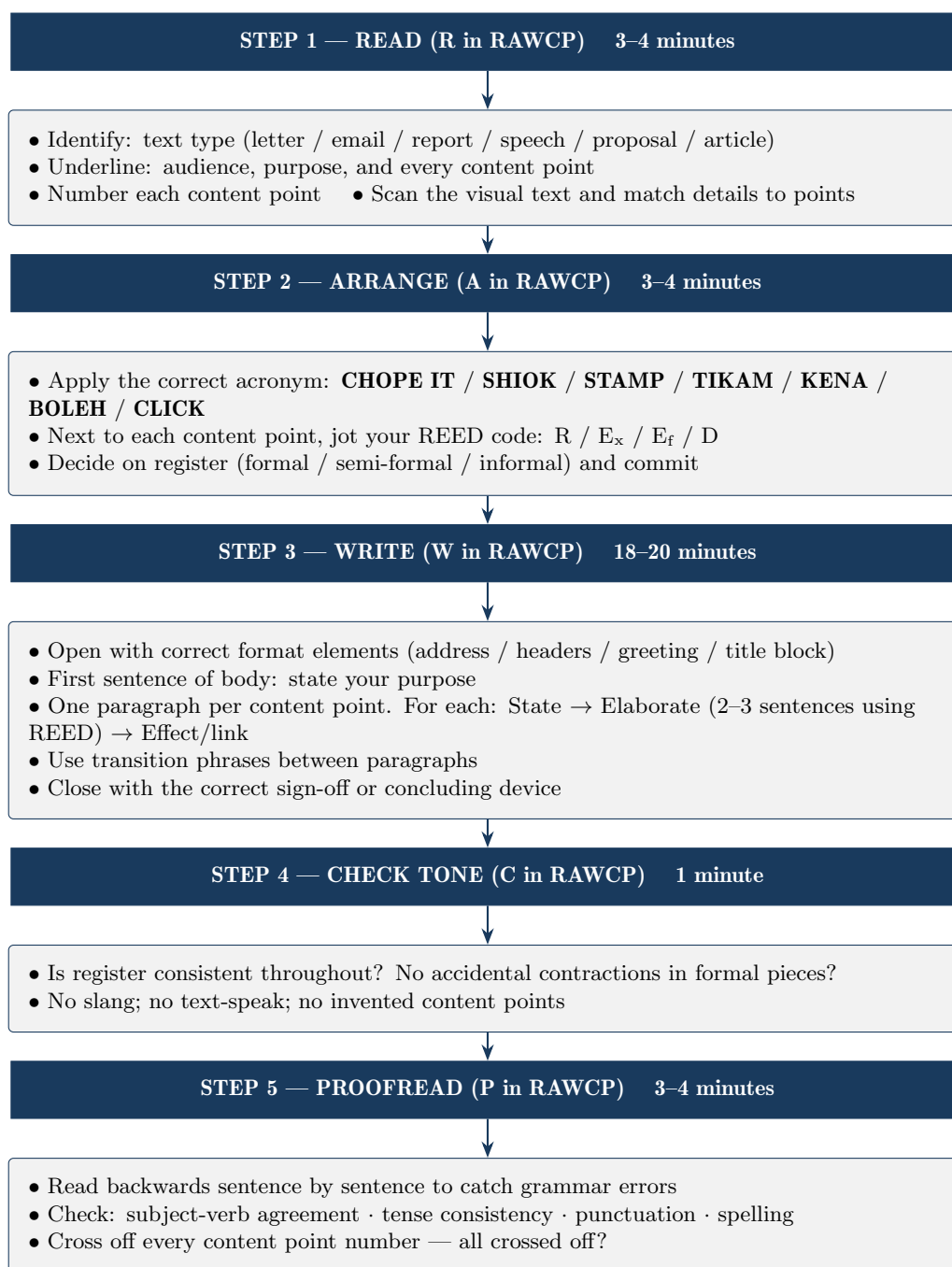
This chapter distils the entire document into three quick-reference tools. Read this first if you are short on time, or use it as a final revision checklist before the exam.

1.1 The Big Picture: What the Examiner Wants

	Task Fulfilment (10 marks)	Language (20 marks)	Key Pitfall
Band 5 (Top)	All points addressed AND developed in detail. Visual text used. PAC fully clear.	Coherent, cohesive. Ambitious vocabulary. Complex structures used accurately.	Losing even one mark by missing one content point
Band 4	All points addressed; at least one developed in detail.	Vocabulary conveys shades of meaning. Mostly accurate.	Addressing all points but elaborating only weakly
Band 3	<i>Most</i> points addressed.	Vocabulary conveys intended meaning. Often accurate.	Stopping here because of missing one content point
Band 1–2	Some or one point only.	Simple structures; variable accuracy.	No plan; writing before reading carefully

Language is worth twice Task Fulfilment. You can lose Task Fulfilment marks by missing one point, but you can also lose Language marks by writing correctly but boringly. Aim for **ambitious vocabulary**, **varied sentences**, and **cohesive paragraphing**.

1.2 The Master Flowchart: From Question to Top Band



1.3 Format Cheat Sheet: All Seven Text Types at a Glance

Text Type	Salutation	Sign-off	Must-Have Elements	Tone	Mnemonic
Formal Letter	Dear [Name], or Dear Sir/Madam,	Yours sincerely (named) Yours faithfully (unnamed)	Sender address · date · recipient address · subject line	Formal	CHOPE IT
Informal Letter	Dear [First Name], or Hi [Name],	Love, / Take care, / Best wishes,	Sender address · date	Informal	SHIOK
Email	Formal: Dear Mr/Mrs [Name], Informal: Hi [Name],	Formal: Regards, Informal: Cheers,	To · From · Date · Subject	Varies	STAMP
Report	None	None (ends with Conclusion)	Title · Prepared by · Submitted to · Date · Section headings	Formal, objective	TIKAM
Speech	Good morning, teachers...	Thank you.	Greeting · hook · call to action	Engaging, persuasive	KENA
Proposal	None	None (ends with Conclusion)	Title · Prepared by · Submitted to · Date · Section headings	Formal, persuasive	BOLEH
Article	None	None (memorable closing line)	Headline · byline · hook	Semi-formal	CLICK

1.4 REED Quick Reference

Code	Stands For	One-Line How-To	Example Sentence Starter
R	Reason	Explain <i>why</i> the point is true or important	“This is because...”
E_x	Example	Give a specific, named instance	“For instance, last year...”
E_f	Effect	State the consequence or impact	“As a result, students would...”
D	Detail	Add who / what / when / where / how	“Specifically, the event will...”

5-Sentence Paragraph Formula (use for every content point):**S1:** Restate the content point in your own words.**S2–3:** Apply REED element 1 (e.g., Reason or Detail) with specific information.**S4–5:** Apply REED element 2 (e.g., Effect or Example) to develop further.

1.5 Band 5 Language Checklist

✓	What Band 5 Looks Like	Example
☐	Ambitious vocabulary (not “good” or “nice”)	“The initiative would cultivate a culture of civic responsibility.”
☐	Mix of simple, compound, and complex sentences	“Although the event is voluntary, we are confident that...”
☐	Cohesive transitions between paragraphs	“Furthermore,” “In light of this,” “Building on the above,”
☐	Consistent register throughout	No “I’m” in a formal letter; no “Yours sincerely” in a casual email
☐	Accurate grammar (subject-verb, tense)	“The students <i>are</i> excited...” not “ <i>is</i> ”
☐	Visual text incorporated and paraphrased	Do not copy word-for-word; rephrase using synonym substitution etc.
☐	Purpose stated in the first sentence of the body	“I am writing to propose...”
☐	Appropriate format elements complete	Addresses, salutation, sign-off, subject line (where required)
☐	Word count within 250–350 words	Aim for 300–320 words: enough for full elaboration; keeps time for Continuous Writing

Chapter 2 Understanding Situational Writing

Situational Writing is Section B of Paper 1. You are given a situation — a scenario with background information — that includes a visual text (such as a poster, flyer, advertisement, or infographic). You must write a piece that responds to the given situation using the correct format, appropriate tone, and all the required content points. You are expected to use information from the visual text to support your ideas.

2.1 How the Question Is Structured

Every Situational Writing question has three key parts that you must read carefully. The question also includes a visual text (such as a poster, flyer, email chain, or infographic) that provides information you should use in your response.

- **(a) The Situation:** Background information that sets the context. It tells you who you are, what has happened, and why you need to write.
- **(b) The Task:** Tells you exactly what you must produce (e.g., a letter, an email, a report, a speech) and who your audience is.
- **(c) The Content Points:** The specific points you must address. They are usually presented as bullet points. You must cover *all* of them.
- **(d) The Visual Text:** Provides additional information (e.g., event details, statistics, schedules) that you should incorporate into your response. Using the given information is part of the Task Fulfilment criteria.

Before you start writing, underline or circle the task word (e.g., “write a letter”), the audience (e.g., “to your principal”), every content point, and the key details from the visual text. This prevents you from missing anything.

2.2 Marking Criteria at a Glance

Criteria	Marks	What Examiners Assess
Task Fulfilment	10	(1) Addressing the required points, (2) Showing awareness of purpose, audience and context (PAC), (3) Using the given information from the visual text
Language	20	(1) Organisation of ideas, (2) Clarity of expression, (3) Accuracy of language (grammar, vocabulary, spelling, punctuation)

Language carries twice the weight of Task Fulfilment (20 marks vs. 10 marks). While addressing all content points is essential for Task Fulfilment, your language quality — vocabulary, grammar, cohesion, and accuracy — ultimately determines whether you reach the top band.

EXAM TIP

Format (e.g., addresses, salutation, sign-off) is not assessed as a separate criterion under Syllabus 1184. However, using the wrong format signals poor awareness of purpose, audience, and context (PAC), which costs you marks under Task Fulfilment. Correct format remains essential — it is assessed through PAC, not

as a standalone penalty.

2.3 Official Band Descriptors

Under Syllabus 1184, Band 5 is the highest and Band 1 is the lowest. This is the reverse of the old 1128 syllabus. The exact SEAB band descriptors are reproduced below.

Task Fulfilment (10 marks)

Band	Marks	Descriptor
5	9–10	All points addressed and developed in detail. Purpose, audience and context fully and clearly addressed. Ideas consistently supported by given information.
4	7–8	All points addressed with one or more developed in detail. Purpose, audience and context clearly addressed. Ideas generally supported by given information.
3	5–6	Most points addressed with some development. Purpose, audience and context addressed. Some attempts to use given information to support ideas.
2	3–4	Some points addressed. Purpose, audience and context partially addressed. Some reference to given information.
1	1–2	One point addressed. Purpose, audience and context occasionally addressed. Occasional reference to given information.
0	0	No creditable response.

Language (20 marks)

Band	Marks	Descriptor
5	17–20	Coherent and cohesive presentation of ideas across the whole of the response. Effective use of ambitious vocabulary and grammar structures. Complex vocabulary, grammar, punctuation and spelling used accurately.
4	13–16	Coherent presentation of ideas with some cohesion between paragraphs. Vocabulary and grammar structures sufficiently varied to convey shades of meaning. Vocabulary, grammar, punctuation and spelling used mostly accurately.
3	9–12	Most ideas coherently presented with some cohesion within paragraphs. Vocabulary and grammar structures sufficiently varied to convey intended meaning. Vocabulary, grammar, punctuation and spelling often used accurately.
2	5–8	Some ideas coherently presented with attempts at achieving cohesion. Mostly simple vocabulary and grammar structures used; meaning is usually clear. Vocabulary, grammar, punctuation and spelling used with varying degrees of accuracy.
1	1–4	Ideas presented in isolation. Simple vocabulary and grammar structures used. A few examples of correct use of vocabulary, grammar, punctuation and spelling.
0	0	No creditable response.

The critical dividing line is between Band 3 and Band 4. For Task Fulfilment, Band 4 requires *all* points addressed; Band 3 only requires *most*. For Language, Band 4 requires vocabulary that conveys “shades of meaning”; Band 3 only requires “intended meaning.” Missing even one content point caps your Task Fulfilment at Band 3.

2.4 Approaching the Visual Text

Every question includes a visual text. Using information from it is one of the three official Task Fulfilment criteria. Follow these three steps:

NOTE: The syllabus refers only to “a visual text” without specifying formats. Common formats in school examinations include posters, flyers, infographics, charts, brochures, programme schedules, and advertisements.

Step	What to Do
1. Number	Number every content point in the question. Watch for double-barrelled points (e.g., “suggest an activity AND explain why” = two points).
2. Match	For each numbered point, find the matching detail in the visual text. Underline it. If no match exists, that point requires your own idea.
3. Cross off	As you write, cross off each point once addressed. After finishing, check: are all numbers crossed off?

The visual text contains more information than you need. Do not try to use everything. Select only what answers the content points. If the visual text offers competing options (e.g., Package A vs. B), pick the one you can elaborate on most convincingly.

Missing even one content point caps your Task Fulfilment at Band 3 (maximum 6 out of 10). The number-match-cross-off method prevents this.

Chapter 3 Types of Situational Writing and Their Formats

The syllabus states that candidates may be required to write a text such as “an email, a letter, a report or a speech.” In practice, schools and past papers also test proposals and articles. Below are the main text types you should prepare for. Know the correct format for each one.

NOTE: The SEAB syllabus explicitly names only four text types: email, letter, report, and speech. The “e.g.” qualifier means the list is not exhaustive. Proposal, article, and the formal/informal letter distinction are school-convention additions not mentioned in the official document, but they are commonly tested in school preliminary examinations.

If the question blends two text types, identify the dominant text type from the question’s stated format and apply its conventions as the primary structure. If the question does not explicitly state the format, default to the text type most implied by the audience and purpose, and err on the side of formality if uncertain.

3.1 Formal Letter

Used when writing to someone in a position of authority or to someone you do not know personally (e.g., a principal, an editor, a company manager).

Remember: CHOPE IT — Your seat at the top band is reserved

C — Correct addresses (sender’s address top right; recipient’s address left-aligned)

H — Header: date in full format (e.g., 15 March 2026, not 15/3/26)

O — Opening: salutation + state purpose in the very first sentence

P — Points: all content points elaborated with REED (2–3 sentences each)

E — Ending: polite closing, offer to follow up, thank the recipient

I — Ink the right sign-off (“Yours faithfully” for unnamed; “Yours sincerely” for named)

T — Tone: formal throughout — no contractions, no slang, no casual language

Format Requirements

- **Sender’s address:** Top right corner.
- **Date:** Below the sender’s address. Use full format: 15 March 2026 (not 15/3/26).
- **Recipient’s details:** Name and address, left-aligned.
- **Salutation:** “Dear Mr/Mrs/Ms [Surname],” or “Dear Sir/Madam,” if the name is unknown.
- **Subject line:** (Highly recommended) Underlined, below the salutation. Immediately clarifies purpose.
- **Body:** Paragraphed. Opening states purpose; middle develops content points; closing is polite.
- **Sign-off:** “Yours faithfully” (Dear Sir/Madam) or “Yours sincerely” (named recipient).
- **Name:** Use the name given in the question. Never use your real name.

“Yours faithfully” pairs with “Dear Sir/Madam.” “Yours sincerely” pairs with a named recipient. Getting this wrong is a common formatting error.

NOTE: Sign-off pairings, format layout, and all specific formatting conventions in this section reflect standard British English practice universally adopted in Singapore schools. They are not stated in the SEAB 1184 syllabus, which assesses format implicitly through awareness of purpose, audience, and context.

Begin your first paragraph clearly: “I am writing to [purpose] regarding [topic].” This immediately signals to the examiner that you understand the task.

Your opening paragraph must state the purpose of the letter in the very first sentence. This is a format expectation, not merely a style choice.

Suggested Paragraph Structure

Paragraph	Sentence-by-Sentence Structure
Opening	State who you are and the purpose of writing. Provide brief context or background.
Body 1 (Point 1)	State the content point in your own words. Give a Reason or Detail. Explain the Effect or provide a specific Example.
Body 2 (Point 2)	Transition and state the next content point. Elaborate with Detail. Explain the expected Effect or outcome.
Body 3 (Point 3)	Transition and state the final content point. Elaborate using any two REED elements.
Closing	Express hope or a polite request. Offer to provide further information. Thank the recipient.

Formal Letter — Scoring Summary

Area	What You Must Do
Format	Sender’s address (top right), date (full format), recipient’s details (left-aligned), salutation, subject line (highly recommended), body paragraphs, correct sign-off, name.
Tone and Register	Formal throughout. No contractions. Use measured, polite language even when complaining or making requests.
Task Fulfilment	Address all content points. Elaborate each with at least 2–3 sentences using REED. Use information from the visual text. State the purpose in the opening sentence.
Language	Varied sentence structures. Precise, ambitious vocabulary. Accurate grammar, spelling, and punctuation. Cohesive paragraphing with transition phrases.
Common Pitfalls	Mismatching sign-off and salutation. Forgetting addresses. Copying content points word for word. Writing only one sentence per content point.
Top-Band Strategy	Plan REED codes next to each content point before writing. Use ambitious vocabulary (e.g., “spearheaded” instead of “did”). Close with a polite, forward-looking statement. Proofread for subject-verb agreement and tense consistency.

3.2 Informal Letter

Used when writing to a friend or family member. The tone is conversational and personal.

Remember: SHIOK — Make your letter feel genuinely warm

S — Start with a warm greeting and ask how they are

H — Heart: share personal anecdotes and genuine feelings
I — Include all content points — do not sacrifice content for a chatty tone
O — Offer advice, encouragement, or reassurance where appropriate
K — Keep it warm — end with a friendly sign-off and your name

Format Requirements

- **Sender's address:** Top right corner (you may keep it brief).
- **Date:** Below the address.
- **Salutation:** "Dear [First Name]," or "Hi [First Name],"
- **No recipient's address:** Not required for informal letters.
- **Body:** Conversational but still paragraphed. Use a friendly opening.
- **Sign-off:** "Yours," "Best wishes," "Take care," or "Love," followed by your name.

Even though the tone is informal, you still need to address all the content points with elaboration. Do not sacrifice content for a chatty tone.

Suggested Paragraph Structure

Paragraph	Sentence-by-Sentence Structure
Opening	Greet your friend warmly and ask how they are. State the reason for writing in a conversational way.
Body 1 (Point 1)	Introduce the content point naturally. Share a personal anecdote or experience as elaboration (Example). Give advice or a suggestion.
Body 2 (Point 2)	Transition naturally. Provide Detail with a specific recommendation. Explain why this would help (Reason or Effect).
Body 3 (Point 3)	Address the final content point. Elaborate with encouragement or reassurance. Add a personal touch.
Closing	End with a warm closing remark. Follow with a friendly sign-off and your name.

Informal Letter — Scoring Summary

Area	What You Must Do
Format	Sender's address (top right), date, greeting, body paragraphs, warm sign-off, name. No recipient address needed.
Tone and Register	Informal and conversational. Contractions are acceptable. Use personal pronouns, share feelings, and write as if speaking to a close friend.
Task Fulfilment	Address all content points with elaboration. Personal anecdotes are excellent REED Examples. The informal tone does not reduce the need for detailed content. Use information from the visual text naturally.
Language	Even informal writing must be grammatically accurate. Vary sentence length. Use engaging vocabulary. Ensure cohesion with natural transitions.
Common Pitfalls	Writing too casually and sacrificing content. Using slang or text-speak. Forgetting to elaborate because the tone feels relaxed. Using a formal sign-off in an informal letter.
Top-Band Strategy	Share a personal anecdote for at least one content point. Show empathy and warmth. Use vivid, specific details instead of vague statements. Close with genuine encouragement or a forward-looking remark.

3.3 Email (Formal or Informal)

Emails may be formal or informal depending on the recipient. The format differs slightly from that of a letter.

Remember: STAMP — Stamp and send with confidence

S — Subject line: clear and specific (e.g., “Proposal for Tree-Planting Activity”, not “Email”)

T — To / From / Date headers — no postal addresses in emails

A — Address the reader with the correct salutation (formal or informal)

M — Main body: content points with REED elaboration, logistical details where needed

P — Polite close: sign-off matching the register (Regards / Cheers) + your name

Format Requirements

- **To:** Recipient’s email address (you may invent a reasonable one).
- **From:** Your email address (optional but demonstrates awareness of format).
- **Date:** Include a date.
- **Subject:** A clear, concise subject line summarising the purpose of the email.
- **Salutation:** “Dear Mr/Mrs [Name],” for formal; “Hi [Name],” for informal.
- **Body:** Paragraphed. May be slightly more concise than a letter but still requires full elaboration of all content points.
- **Sign-off:** “Regards,” or “Best regards,” for formal; “Cheers,” for informal.

A good subject line shows the examiner you understand the purpose. For example, “Request for Permission to Organise a Fundraiser” is far more effective than “Letter” or “Email.”

Unlike a formal letter, an email does not require sender’s or recipient’s postal addresses. Do not include them.

Suggested Paragraph Structure (Formal Email)

Paragraph	Sentence-by-Sentence Structure
Opening	State your purpose directly. Provide brief context (e.g., your role or the background to the request).
Body 1 (Point 1)	State the content point clearly. Elaborate with Reason or Detail. Explain the Effect or expected outcome.
Body 2 (Point 2)	Transition (e.g., “In terms of logistics,...”). Provide specific Details (dates, times, locations, numbers). Add any necessary logistical information.
Body 3 (Point 3)	State the final content point with a transition. Elaborate with Effect or Example.
Closing	Express hope for a positive response. Offer to provide more information if required. Thank the recipient. End with sign-off and name.

For an informal email, follow the same structure as the Informal Letter but replace the postal address and date with email headers (To, From, Date, Subject). Use a casual greeting and sign-off.

Email — Scoring Summary

Area	What You Must Do
Format	To, From, Date, Subject line, salutation, body paragraphs, sign-off, name. No postal addresses. The subject line must clearly reflect the purpose.
Tone and Register	Depends on audience. Formal email to a teacher: no contractions, polite and measured. Informal email to a friend: conversational and warm. Commit to one register throughout.
Task Fulfilment	Address all content points. Elaborate each with REED. Use information from the visual text (e.g., dates, times, venue details).
Language	Concise and clear. Varied sentence structures. Accurate grammar and spelling. Logical flow with appropriate connectors.
Common Pitfalls	Including postal addresses. Writing a vague subject line. Mixing registers. Forgetting the To/From/Date/Subject header entirely.
Top-Band Strategy	Write a precise subject line that mirrors the purpose. Be specific with logistical details. For formal emails, close with a polite request and an offer to provide further information.

3.4 Report

A report is a factual and structured account written for a specific audience (e.g., a principal, a committee, a teacher). It presents findings, observations, or recommendations.

Remember: TIKAM — Do not leave your marks to chance

T — Title + Prepared by + Submitted to + Date (the header block)

I — Introduction: state the purpose and scope of the report in the first sentence

K — Key findings: specific data, observations, and details from the visual text

A — Actions: recommendations that are linked to your findings

M — Make a conclusion: summarise the overall outcome with a forward-looking statement

Format Requirements

- **Title:** Centred at the top. Clearly state the subject (e.g., “Report on the School Canteen Facilities”).
- **Prepared by / Submitted to:** Include who wrote the report and who it is for.
- **Date:** Include the date.
- **Section headings:** Use clear headings for each section (e.g., “Introduction,” “Findings,” “Recommendations,” “Conclusion”).
- **Tone:** Formal, objective, and impersonal. Avoid “I think” or personal opinions unless the question asks for recommendations.

Reports look very different from letters and emails. Using section headings is expected and helps you organise your content points logically. Group related content points under the same heading.

Your Introduction section must state the purpose and scope of the report in the very first sentence (e.g., “This report provides an account of...”). This sets the context for the reader immediately.

Suggested Section Structure

Section	Sentence-by-Sentence Structure
1. Introduction	State the purpose and scope of the report. Provide key background details (e.g., who attended, where, when).
2. Findings / Activities	State what was observed or carried out. Provide specific Details (times, locations, descriptions of activities). Include data or observations where relevant.
3. Feedback / Results	Summarise the overall response or outcome. Provide a specific positive finding with Detail. Note any areas of concern with an Example.
4. Recommendations	State your first recommendation clearly. Explain the Reason behind it (linked to findings). State a second recommendation and explain its expected Effect.
5. Conclusion	Summarise the overall outcome. End with a forward-looking statement linking to the recommendations.

Report — Scoring Summary

Area	What You Must Do
Format	Title (centred), Prepared by, Submitted to, Date, section headings (Introduction, Findings, Feedback, Recommendations, Conclusion). No salutation or sign-off.
Tone and Register	Formal, objective, and factual. Write in the third person where possible. Avoid emotional language or personal opinions unless the task asks for recommendations.
Task Fulfilment	Address all content points under appropriate section headings. Use specific data from the visual text (numbers, percentages, survey results). State the purpose in the Introduction. Link Recommendations to Findings.
Language	Clear and precise. Use formal connectors (“Furthermore,” “As a result,” “In light of the findings”). Accurate grammar, especially subject-verb agreement and tense consistency.
Common Pitfalls	Writing a report like a letter (with salutation and sign-off). Omitting section headings. Providing vague findings without specific data. Writing recommendations that do not connect to the findings.
Top-Band Strategy	Use numbered or clearly labelled section headings. Include at least one specific statistic or data point from the visual text. Make every recommendation actionable and linked to a finding. Keep the tone consistently objective.

3.5 Speech

A speech is delivered orally to an audience. In the exam, you write the script of the speech. It requires an engaging and persuasive tone.

Remember: KENA — Make sure your speech KENA the audience

K — Kick off with a greeting and a powerful hook (rhetorical question, striking fact, bold statement)

E — Engage the audience: use “you,” “we,” “us,” and rhetorical devices throughout

N — Narrate your content points with energy, specific Details, and inclusive language

A — Ask them to act: deliver a clear call to action, then close with “Thank you”

Format Requirements

- **Greeting/Address:** Open by addressing the audience (e.g., “Good morning, teachers and fellow students.”).
- **Introduction:** State your purpose and capture attention. Use a rhetorical question, a striking fact, or a brief anecdote.
- **Body:** Address content points in a persuasive and engaging manner. Use rhetorical devices (questions, tripling, direct address using “you” and “we”).
- **Conclusion:** End with a strong closing statement or a call to action. Thank the audience.
- **Tone:** Engaging, persuasive, and appropriate to the audience. More emotive language is acceptable compared to a report.

A speech must sound like it is meant to be spoken aloud. Use direct address (“you,” “we,” “us”) and rhetorical questions to create a sense of connection with the audience.

Do not write a speech as if it were a letter. There is no salutation like “Dear” and no sign-off like “Yours sincerely.” A speech uses a greeting and a concluding thank-you.

Suggested Paragraph Structure

Paragraph	Sentence-by-Sentence Structure
Opening	Greet the audience. Introduce yourself and your role if relevant. Hook the audience with a rhetorical question, a startling fact, or a bold statement.
Body 1 (Point 1)	State the content point clearly using direct address. Provide a Reason or real-world Example. Describe the Effect on the audience or community.
Body 2 (Point 2)	Transition with energy. Provide specific Details (date, time, venue, activities, what to bring). Use inclusive language.
Body 3 (Point 3)	Address the final content point with a transition. Provide practical Details.
Closing	Summarise the key message or make a call to action. End on an inspiring or memorable note. Thank the audience.

Speech — Scoring Summary

Area	What You Must Do
Format	Greeting (e.g., “Good morning, teachers and fellow students.”), well-paragraphed body, call to action, thank-you closing. No addresses, no date header, no sign-off.
Tone and Register	Engaging, persuasive, and spoken in style. Use direct address (“you,” “we,” “us”) and inclusive language. The tone can be passionate but must remain respectful.
Task Fulfilment	Address all content points. Use information from the visual text (e.g., event details, statistics). Each point must be elaborated with REED, not merely listed.
Language	Use rhetorical devices: rhetorical questions, repetition for emphasis, tricolons (groups of three). Vary sentence length for rhythm. Maintain grammatical accuracy throughout.
Common Pitfalls	Writing a speech as if it were a letter. Flat, factual tone with no audience engagement. Failing to include a call to action. Overusing rhetorical questions (use at most one per section).
Top-Band Strategy	Open with a strong hook (rhetorical question or striking fact). Use at least two different rhetorical devices. Include specific details from the visual text. Build towards a powerful closing that motivates the audience to act.

3.6 Proposal

A proposal suggests a plan of action. It is structured and persuasive, written to convince the reader to approve or support an idea.

Remember: BOLEH — Convince the reader: this plan BOLEH work

B — Big idea: state the objective clearly in the first section

O — Outline the plan of action with specific details (who, when, where, how)

L — List the benefits with evidence or examples to persuade

E — Expect concerns: acknowledge and counter potential objections

H — Hope for approval: conclude by restating the strongest benefit and requesting support

Format Requirements

- **Title:** Centred (e.g., “Proposal for a School Recycling Programme”).
- **Prepared by / Submitted to:** State who the proposal is from and to whom it is directed.
- **Date:** Include the date.
- **Section headings:** Use headings such as “Objective,” “Plan of Action,” “Benefits,” “Addressing Concerns,” “Conclusion.”
- **Tone:** Formal and persuasive. Body paragraphs must focus on convincing the reader by presenting clear benefits and anticipating concerns.

A proposal is very similar to a report in format, but its purpose is to persuade rather than simply inform. A report describes what happened; a proposal argues for what should happen. Keep this distinction in mind when choosing your language.

Suggested Section Structure

Section	Sentence-by-Sentence Structure
1. Objective	State the aim of the proposal. Explain the Reason or need.
2. Plan of Action	Describe the proposed plan clearly. Provide specific Details (who, when, where, how often, what activities). Mention logistics such as resources, supervision, or budget.
3. Benefits	State the first benefit clearly. Explain the Effect on students. State a second benefit. Support with an Example or evidence (e.g., a similar programme at another school).
4. Addressing Concerns	Acknowledge a potential concern. Counter it with a Reason and a practical solution.
5. Conclusion	Restate the main benefit to persuade. Request approval or support politely.

Proposal — Scoring Summary

Area	What You Must Do
Format	Title, Prepared by, Submitted to, Date, section headings (Objective, Plan of Action, Benefits, Addressing Concerns, Conclusion). No salutation or sign-off.
Tone and Register	Formal and persuasive. Unlike a report (which is objective), a proposal actively argues for a course of action. Use language that highlights benefits and addresses concerns.
Task Fulfilment	Address all content points under clear headings. Use information from the visual text. Present concrete benefits. Anticipate and address at least one potential concern.
Language	Persuasive vocabulary (“significantly improve,” “greatly benefit,” “effectively address”). Use conditional structures (“This would enable...,” “Students would gain...”). Clear paragraph organisation under each heading.
Common Pitfalls	Writing a proposal like a report (describing what happened instead of arguing for what should happen). Listing benefits without explaining them. Failing to anticipate objections.
Top-Band Strategy	Include an “Addressing Concerns” section. Support at least one benefit with evidence or an Example. Use action-oriented language. Close by restating the strongest benefit and politely requesting approval.

3.7 Article (for a School Newsletter or Magazine)

An article informs or entertains readers. It is written for a wider audience and should be engaging.

Remember: CLICK — Make readers want to CLICK and keep reading

C — Catchy headline + byline (e.g., “By [Name], Staff Reporter”)

L — Lead with a hook: a question, bold claim, or striking fact to grab the reader

I — Illustrate with named examples and anecdotes (specific students, CCAs, events)

C — Connect content points with lively transitions and an engaging tone

K — Kick-end: close with a memorable line, a call to action, or a thought-provoking question

Format Requirements

- **Headline:** A catchy and relevant title that attracts the reader.
- **Byline:** “By [Your Name]” below the headline.
- **Introduction:** A strong opening that hooks the reader (a question, a surprising fact, or a vivid description).
- **Body:** Well-paragraphed content addressing all content points. May use subheadings if appropriate.
- **Conclusion:** A memorable closing that ties the article together.
- **Tone:** Semi-formal to informal depending on the publication. Lively and reader-friendly.

Suggested Paragraph Structure

Paragraph	Sentence-by-Sentence Structure
Headline + Byline	A catchy, informative headline. Your byline (e.g., “By [Name], Staff Reporter”).
Opening	Open with a hook (a question, a bold claim, or a striking fact). Introduce the topic and its relevance to the school audience.
Body 1 (Point 1)	State the first main argument or point. Provide a Reason. Give a concrete Example (a named student, a specific CCA, a real scenario).
Body 2 (Point 2)	Transition and introduce the next point. Elaborate with a second Example or a brief anecdote. Explain the Effect or wider significance.
Body 3 (Point 3)	Address the final content point. Elaborate with Detail and Effect, keeping the tone lively and engaging for a student readership.
Closing	Summarise the main message. End with a memorable statement, a call to action, or a thought-provoking question.

Article — Scoring Summary

Area	What You Must Do
Format	Catchy headline (centred or bold), byline (e.g., “By [Name], Staff Reporter”), well-paragraphed body with an engaging opening hook and a memorable closing. No salutation, no sign-off, no addresses.
Tone and Register	Semi-formal to informal, depending on the publication. Lively and reader-friendly. Personal voice is acceptable.
Task Fulfilment	Address all content points with elaboration. Use information from the visual text. Include realistic Examples (named students, specific CCAs, concrete events). Open with a hook and close with a memorable line.
Language	Engaging vocabulary suited to a student readership. Mix of sentence types for rhythm and readability. Rhetorical questions and direct address are appropriate. Accurate grammar, spelling, and punctuation.
Common Pitfalls	Forgetting the headline and byline. Writing in a flat, report-like tone. Making general claims without specific Examples. Ending abruptly without a memorable closing.
Top-Band Strategy	Craft a headline that captures attention. Open with a hook that makes the reader want to continue. Use at least two named Examples for specificity. Close with a thought-provoking question or a call to action.

Chapter 4 Written Samples for Each Text Type

Study these model responses carefully. Each sample demonstrates the correct format, appropriate tone, and effective elaboration of content points. The annotations explain why each response is capable of achieving the top marking band (Band 5 for Task Fulfilment; Band 5 for Language) under SEAB Syllabus 1184.

4.1 Formal Letter

Scenario: You are the Head Prefect of Greenfield Secondary School. The school is planning its annual Kindness Week. Write a formal letter to the Principal, Mrs Tan Mei Ling, requesting her permission to organise the event. You should include the purpose of Kindness Week, the activities planned, and the benefits to the school community. The poster below provides details you should use.

Greenfield Secondary School
10 Greenfield Avenue, Singapore 456123

15 March 2026

Mrs Tan Mei Ling
Principal
Greenfield Secondary School
10 Greenfield Avenue, Singapore 456123

Dear Mrs Tan,

Request for Permission to Organise Kindness Week

I am writing to seek your permission to organise this year's Kindness Week, to be held from 5 to 9 May 2026. As Head Prefect, I firmly believe that this initiative would cultivate a culture of empathy and mutual respect that extends well beyond the event itself.

The purpose of Kindness Week is to encourage students to practise deliberate acts of kindness in their daily interactions. Recent feedback gathered by the student council indicates that a notable proportion of students feel socially isolated during recess, and this event has been designed specifically to address that concern. By creating structured opportunities for positive engagement, we hope to foster a more cohesive and inclusive school environment.

To this end, we have planned three activities across the week. On Monday, students will contribute anonymous notes of encouragement, which will be collected in a Kindness Mailbox placed outside the general office and redistributed to classmates. On Wednesday, each class will participate in a buddy lunch, pairing students across different form groups to share a meal and form new connections. The week will culminate on Friday with a closing assembly at which student representatives will reflect on their experiences, reinforcing the values underpinning the initiative.

Beyond the immediate impact of these activities, Kindness Week would yield lasting benefits for the school community. It would strengthen inter-class relationships, reduce instances of social exclusion, and affirm the school's core values of empathy and civic responsibility. Furthermore, participation in the planning and execution of these activities would provide student leaders with invaluable experience in project management and communication.

I hope you will give this proposal your favourable consideration. The student council and I would be delighted to present a more detailed plan at your earliest convenience. Thank you for your time and support.

Yours sincerely,
Zhang Wei
Head Prefect, Greenfield Secondary School

Task Fulfilment (Band 5): All three content points — purpose, activities, and benefits — are addressed and developed in detail. Each is elaborated over multiple sentences using REED: the Purpose paragraph uses Reason (address social isolation) and Effect (foster cohesion); the Activities paragraph uses Detail (three named activities with specific days and mechanics); the Benefits paragraph uses Effect (strengthen relationships, reduce exclusion) and Reason (affirm core values). The visual text information (dates, specific activities) is woven in naturally and paraphrased rather than copied.

Language (Band 5): Ambitious vocabulary throughout — “cultivate,” “cohesive,” “underpinning,” “invaluable,” “civic responsibility.” Sentence structures vary between simple (“Thank you for your time and support.”), compound-complex (“By creating structured opportunities. . . , we hope to foster. . .”), and complex (“Beyond the immediate impact. . .”). Cohesive transitions (“To this end,” “Furthermore,” “Beyond the immediate impact”) link paragraphs. Tone is consistently formal with no contractions. Sign-off correctly paired with the named recipient.

4.2 Informal Letter

Scenario: Your close friend Sarah has just told you that she will be transferring to a new school next term and is feeling anxious about fitting in. Write a letter to Sarah offering her advice on how to settle in, sharing your own experience of being new at a school, and suggesting specific ways to make friends. The flyer below provides some ideas you should use.

23 Bukit Timah Road
Singapore 259878

20 March 2026

Dear Sarah,

How are you holding up? When I heard that you would be transferring to Riverside Secondary next term, my very first thought was: I need to write to you, because I know exactly how you feel right now — and I promise it is going to be all right.

When I transferred to Evergreen Secondary at the start of Secondary Two, I was convinced that I would never belong. I spent my first week eating alone at the corner of the canteen, too self-conscious to approach anyone. What turned things around was something surprisingly simple: I made eye contact, smiled, and one afternoon asked the girl sitting opposite me if the chicken rice was worth queuing for. That was how I met my best friend, Priya. The lesson I would pass on to you is this — be the one who reaches out first. Most students are far more welcoming than they appear, and a small act of openness can be the beginning of something lasting.

Another piece of advice I wish someone had given me is to join a co-curricular activity as early as possible. CCAs place you alongside students who already share your interests, which instantly gives you common ground. I joined the Drama Club in my second week, and by the first rehearsal I had half a dozen conversations without even trying. There is truly no faster way to feel at home. If you enjoy music, sport, or anything creative, sign up without hesitation — you will thank yourself later.

Above all, please be patient with yourself. Settling in takes time, and it is perfectly normal to feel out of place for the first few weeks. What matters is that you keep showing up with an open heart. I am only a message away whenever you need to talk, and I genuinely cannot wait to hear how things unfold for you.

Take care, Sarah, and write back soon!

Love,
Jun Wei

WHY THIS WORKS

Task Fulfilment (Band 5): All three content points — advice on settling in, personal experience, and ways to make friends — are addressed and developed in detail. The Advice paragraph uses Reason (“most

students are far more welcoming than they appear”) and a concrete Example (eye contact, a simple question, meeting Priya); the Experience paragraph uses a vivid narrative Example (eating alone, then the chicken rice encounter); the CCA paragraph uses Detail (Drama Club, second week, half a dozen conversations) and Effect (common ground, feeling at home). Each point is elaborated across multiple sentences, well beyond a superficial mention.

Language (Band 5): Ambitious vocabulary — “self-conscious,” “common ground,” “cohesion,” “openness,” “lasting.” Sentence variety: short, punchy sentences (“I promise it is going to be all right.”) contrast with longer, embedded clauses (“What turned things around was something surprisingly simple. . .”). Register is warmly informal throughout without slipping into slang or text-speak. Natural transitions between paragraphs (“Another piece of advice,” “Above all”). The closing is personal and encouraging.

4.3 Formal Email

Scenario: You are the Secretary of the Environmental Club at Greenfield Secondary School. Write a formal email to your teacher-in-charge, Mr David Lim, proposing a tree-planting activity. Your email should cover the objectives of the activity, the logistics, and the expected outcomes. The flyer below provides details you should incorporate.

To: david.lim@greenfield.edu.sg

From: priya.nair@greenfield.edu.sg

Date: 18 March 2026

Subject: Proposal for Environmental Club Tree-Planting Activity — 12 April 2026

Dear Mr Lim,

I am writing to propose a tree-planting activity for the Environmental Club, to be held on Saturday, 12 April 2026. Having discussed the idea with the committee at last week’s meeting, we are confident that this would be both an educationally enriching and practically meaningful experience for all members.

The primary objective of this activity is to deepen students’ understanding of urban ecology and to provide them with a hands-on opportunity to contribute to environmental conservation. This aligns directly with the school’s Values-in-Action framework, allowing club members to translate their classroom learning about sustainability into tangible community action. Equipping students with this sense of agency, we believe, is as valuable as any formal lesson.

In terms of logistics, we propose holding the activity at East Coast Park from 8.00 a.m. to 12.00 p.m. The National Parks Board has confirmed its willingness to supply saplings, gardening gloves, and tools at no cost to the school. Transportation can be arranged via two school buses, and we would require the supervision of two to three teachers. We anticipate a total of 30 participants, comprising all current club members.

We expect this activity to yield several meaningful outcomes. Participating students would develop a stronger sense of environmental stewardship, while the collaborative nature of the work would foster teamwork and camaraderie among club members from different year groups. Additionally, the event offers a positive visibility opportunity for the school: with your approval, we would document the activity and submit a write-up to the school newsletter, potentially inspiring wider student participation in future initiatives.

I hope you will give this proposal your favourable consideration. I am happy to provide a detailed budget breakdown and a full risk-assessment form if required. Thank you for your continued guidance and support.

Best regards,

Priya Nair

Secretary, Environmental Club

WHY THIS WORKS

Task Fulfilment (Band 5): All three content points — objectives, logistics, and outcomes — are addressed and developed in detail. The Objectives paragraph uses Reason (deepen understanding, align with VIA) and Effect (sense of agency); the Logistics paragraph uses Detail (East Coast Park, 8 a.m.–12 p.m., NParks

supplying equipment, 30 participants, two school buses); the Outcomes paragraph uses Effect (stewardship, teamwork, school visibility) and Example (newsletter write-up). Visual text details (date, venue, equipment) are incorporated and paraphrased.

Language (Band 5): Ambitious vocabulary — “urban ecology,” “tangible community action,” “stewardship,” “camaraderie,” “visibility opportunity.” Complex sentence structures (“Equipping students with this sense of agency, we believe, is as valuable as any formal lesson”) alongside concise factual sentences for logistics. Cohesive connectors (“In terms of logistics,” “Additionally,” “with your approval”). Subject line is specific and informative. Consistent formal register; no contractions. Correct email format with no postal addresses.

4.4 Report

Scenario: As Class Chairperson of 4A, write a report to your form teacher, Ms Wong Siew Ping, on the class outing to the Singapore Science Centre held on 10 March 2026. Your report should cover the activities carried out, student feedback, and recommendations for future outings. The feedback summary sheet below provides data you should incorporate.

Worked Example — Report

Report on Class Outing to the Singapore Science Centre

Prepared by: Amirah Binte Ismail, Class Chairperson, 4A

Submitted to: Ms Wong Siew Ping, Form Teacher, 4A

Date: 22 March 2026

1. Introduction

This report provides a comprehensive account of the class outing to the Singapore Science Centre held on 10 March 2026. A total of 38 students and two accompanying teachers participated in the visit, which formed part of the class’s enrichment programme for the year.

2. Activities Carried Out

Students arrived at the Science Centre at 9.00 a.m. and were given a facilitated tour of the Physical Sciences gallery, which featured interactive exhibits on the principles of forces and energy. Following the tour, students participated in a hands-on DNA extraction workshop conducted by the centre’s education team, during which they extracted DNA from strawberries using everyday materials. The outing concluded with a period of self-directed exploration of the remaining galleries from 11.30 a.m. to 1.00 p.m., allowing students to pursue topics of personal interest.

3. Student Feedback

A structured survey was administered upon the class’s return to school, yielding a strong positive response: 35 out of 38 students (92%) rated the overall experience as either “excellent” or “good.” The DNA extraction workshop was cited as the highlight by the majority of respondents, with several students noting that the practical, inquiry-based format made abstract concepts considerably more accessible. However, a recurring piece of feedback was that the facilitated gallery tour felt rushed, with insufficient time allocated to each exhibit. Three students also suggested that a pre-visit briefing on the exhibits would have enhanced their engagement.

4. Recommendations

In light of the above findings, two recommendations are proposed. First, it is recommended that future outings limit the number of galleries visited to two or three, prioritising depth of engagement over breadth. This would allow students to interact meaningfully with each exhibit and ask questions of the facilitators, maximising the educational value of the visit. Second, it would be beneficial to assign a short pre-visit research task in which students explore one topic area of the gallery in advance. Based on feedback from similar initiatives at Northlight Secondary, this approach has been shown to increase student engagement by approximately 30%.

5. Conclusion

Overall, the outing was a well-received and educationally purposeful event that successfully complemented

the class's academic curriculum. With the adjustments outlined above, future visits would be even more impactful and continue to strengthen students' enthusiasm for Science learning beyond the classroom.

Task Fulfilment (Band 5): All three content points — activities, feedback, and recommendations — are addressed and developed in detail under clearly numbered section headings. The Activities section uses Detail (specific times, named gallery, DNA workshop with the strawberry detail, self-directed exploration period); the Feedback section uses Detail (92% positive, 35/38 students) and Example (DNA workshop praised, tour criticised, pre-visit briefing suggestion); the Recommendations section uses Reason (depth over breadth) and Effect (maximise educational value), with an external Example (Northlight Secondary data). Visual text data is incorporated and paraphrased throughout.

Language (Band 5): Ambitious vocabulary — “facilitated,” “inquiry-based,” “self-directed,” “maximising,” “educationally purposeful.” Third-person objective tone maintained throughout. Formal connectors (“In light of the above findings,” “Based on feedback from...,” “With the adjustments outlined above”). Sentence structures vary from concise factual statements to complex analytical sentences. No first-person opinions; the one exception (the Recommendations section) is appropriate because the task calls for recommendations. Accurate grammar and punctuation throughout.

4.5 Speech

Scenario: You are the President of the Student Council at Greenfield Secondary School. Deliver a speech at a school assembly to persuade students to volunteer for an upcoming community clean-up event. Your speech should explain why the event matters, describe what it involves, and tell students how they can sign up. The event details poster below provides information you should use.

Good morning, teachers and fellow students.

I have a question for you. The next time you walk through our neighbourhood and spot a pile of litter collecting by the void deck, what do you do? Do you look away, tell yourself it is someone else's problem, and carry on? Or do you stop and think: I could be the one who does something about this? Today, I am here to invite each and every one of you to be the latter.

Our upcoming community clean-up event is not simply about picking up litter. It is about something far more significant. The state of our shared spaces is a direct reflection of the values of the people who inhabit them. When we allow our parks, walkways, and common corridors to fall into neglect, we implicitly communicate that we do not care — about our environment, our neighbours, or each other. And yet, research conducted by the National Environment Agency has found that residents who participate in community clean-up activities report a 40% greater sense of belonging to their neighbourhood than those who do not. Our collective effort, however small it may seem, has a measurable impact on the community we share.

So what exactly does this event involve? On Saturday, 26 April, from 8.00 a.m. to 11.00 a.m., volunteers will assemble at the void deck of Block 123, Tampines Street 45. We will divide into small groups and systematically cover the surrounding parks, pedestrian walkways, and common areas. Gloves, refuse bags, and litter-picking tools will be provided in full by the Residents' Committee — all you need to bring is your commitment and your energy.

Signing up could not be simpler. Approach any Student Council member during recess this week, or scan the QR code displayed on the notice board outside the general office. We are aiming for at least 50 volunteers, and every single name on that list brings us one step closer to a cleaner, more caring neighbourhood.

This is our community. These are our shared spaces. This is our moment to act. Let us not be the generation that inherits a neighbourhood and leaves it worse than we found it. Let us be the generation that rolls up its sleeves, steps forward, and makes a difference. I urge each of you to sign up this week. Together, we will show that Greenfield students do not merely speak about values — we embody them.

Thank you.

Task Fulfilment (Band 5): All three content points — why the event matters, what it involves, and how to sign up — are addressed and developed in detail. The Why It Matters section uses Reason (spaces reflect community values), Effect (sense of belonging), and a specific statistic (NEA research: 40% greater sense of belonging) rather than a vague “research shows” claim; the What It Involves section uses Detail (26 April, 8–11 a.m., Block 123 Tampines, equipment provided); the How to Sign Up section uses Detail (Student Council members, QR code, target of 50 volunteers). Visual text details are incorporated and paraphrased.

Language (Band 5): Ambitious vocabulary — “implicitly communicate,” “collective effort,” “measurable impact,” “systematically,” “embody.” Multiple rhetorical devices: rhetorical questions (opening), tricolon (“This is our community... These are our shared spaces... This is our moment”), direct address (“you,” “we,” “us,” “our”), and repetition for emphasis (“Let us be... Let us not be...”). Sentence variety ranges from short, punchy imperatives (“Thank you.”) to long, complex persuasive structures. Consistent engaging register; no inappropriate formality or slang.

4.6 Proposal

Scenario: As Vice-Chairperson of the Student Welfare Committee, write a proposal to the Vice-Principal, Mr Ong Kian Huat, suggesting a peer mentoring programme for lower secondary students. Your proposal should outline the objectives, how the programme will work, the expected benefits, and any potential concerns with your responses to them. The programme brief below provides details you should use.

Worked Example — Proposal

Proposal for a Peer Mentoring Programme for Lower Secondary Students

Prepared by: Lim Jia Xuan, Vice-Chairperson, Student Welfare Committee

Submitted to: Mr Ong Kian Huat, Vice-Principal

Date: 25 March 2026

1. Objective

This proposal outlines a structured peer mentoring programme designed to support Secondary One and Two students in their academic adjustment and social integration. Given that the transition to secondary school is consistently identified in student welfare surveys as one of the most stressful periods of a young person’s school experience, this programme seeks to provide timely, personalised guidance from senior students who have navigated the same challenges.

2. How the Programme Will Work

Selected Secondary Three and Four students will be recruited and trained as peer mentors, with each mentor assigned two to three mentees from the lower secondary cohort. Mentors and mentees will meet once a week during the extended recess period on Wednesdays, a session lasting approximately 30 minutes. During these sessions, mentors will assist their mentees with study strategies, time management, and any social or school-life concerns that arise. A supervising teacher will oversee each cohort of mentors and provide structured training at the start of each academic term, ensuring consistency and quality of support.

3. Expected Benefits

The programme would yield significant benefits for both parties. Lower secondary students would receive personalised academic support and, crucially, a sense of belonging — a factor strongly correlated with improved school satisfaction and reduced attrition. Senior students, in turn, would develop leadership, empathy, and interpersonal communication skills of demonstrable value in future endeavours. Schools with established peer mentoring programmes, such as St Joseph’s Institution and Northview Secondary, have reported measurable improvements in both student well-being indices and academic outcomes for mentee cohorts.

4. Addressing Concerns

It is acknowledged that some may raise concerns about the additional time commitment for mentor students who are already managing demanding academic schedules. However, as sessions are limited to 30 minutes per week and are conducted during an existing free period, the impact on study time would be minimal.

Furthermore, the programme would be purely voluntary, ensuring that only students who are both willing and adequately resourced in terms of time would participate. A mid-term review would also allow the supervising teacher to identify and support any mentors experiencing difficulty.

5. Conclusion

I am fully confident that this programme would meaningfully strengthen the pastoral support infrastructure of our school and create a more nurturing environment for our youngest students. I would welcome the opportunity to present this proposal in greater detail at a time convenient to you. Thank you for your consideration.

Task Fulfilment (Band 5): All four content points — objective, how the programme works, expected benefits, and addressing concerns — are developed in detail under numbered section headings. The Objective uses Reason (transition stress identified in welfare surveys); the How It Works section uses Detail (weekly 30-minute Wednesday sessions, 2–3 mentees, end-of-term training, supervising teacher); the Benefits section uses Effect (belonging, reduced attrition, leadership skills) and external Example (SJI and Northview Secondary data); the Addressing Concerns section uses Reason (sessions are voluntary, during free periods) and a practical solution (mid-term review). This is the section most commonly missing from student proposals; its inclusion signals maturity of thinking.

Language (Band 5): Ambitious vocabulary — “attrition,” “demonstrable,” “interpersonal,” “pastoral support infrastructure,” “correlated.” Persuasive conditional structures (“would yield,” “would develop,” “would be”) distinguish this from a descriptive report. Complex sentence structures with embedded clauses alternate with shorter declarative sentences for rhythmic variety. Consistent formal, persuasive register. Accurate grammar and punctuation.

4.7 Article

Scenario: Write an article for your school magazine about the importance of co-curricular activities (CCAs). Your article should explain why CCAs matter, share examples of how students have benefited, and encourage students to participate actively.

Worked Example — Article

More Than Just a Grade: Why CCAs Deserve Your Full Commitment

By Kavitha Rajan, Staff Reporter

Ask any student what they will remember most about secondary school in ten years’ time, and the answer is rarely a formula or a date. It is almost always something that happened in a CCA room: a performance they were terrified to give, a match they nearly did not win, a friendship they nearly did not make. Co-curricular activities are, for many students, the most formative part of their school experience — and yet, too many students treat them as an obligation to be minimised rather than an opportunity to be seized.

The reason CCAs matter has nothing to do with how they look on a Direct School Admission form, though they certainly help there too. They matter because they develop competencies that the classroom simply cannot replicate. A student who commits to the Debate Club cultivates the ability to think rigorously under pressure and articulate complex ideas with confidence and precision. A member of the Basketball team learns what discipline, resilience, and collective accountability look like in practice. These are not soft skills — they are the foundational skills of every rewarding career and meaningful relationship a person will ever have.

The evidence is not merely theoretical. Last year, Faridah Binte Othman from 4B credited her two years in the Red Cross Society with giving her the calm, the composure, and the sense of purpose that enabled her to secure a place through the Polytechnic Early Admissions Exercise. “The CCA taught me how to show up, even when I did not feel ready,” she said. Similarly, Rui Jie from 3C — who by his own admission barely said a word in class during Secondary One — found his voice through the Drama Club and went on to host the school’s National Day concert in Secondary Three. These are not exceptional stories. They are the stories that CCAs produce, reliably, year after year.

If you have been treating your CCA as something to endure rather than embrace, consider reframing your approach. Attend with intention. Set a personal goal for each term. Volunteer for a leadership role before you feel ready. The growth happens precisely in that uncomfortable space between where you are and where you want to be. Your future self — the one who is grateful, capable, and connected — is waiting for you there.

Task Fulfilment (Band 5): All three content points — why CCAs matter, student examples, and encouragement to participate — are addressed and developed in detail. The Why It Matters paragraph uses Reason (develop competencies the classroom cannot replicate) and concrete Examples (Debate Club for precision thinking, Basketball for collective accountability); the Student Examples paragraph uses named, specific Examples with attributed quotation (Faridah’s EAE success, Rui Jie’s transformation) and Effect (reliable, year-on-year outcomes); the Closing paragraph provides a direct, detailed call to action (attend with intention, set goals, volunteer for leadership). The visual text is engaged with throughout.

Language (Band 5): Ambitious vocabulary — “rigorously,” “replicate,” “foundational,” “composure,” “formative,” “collective accountability.” Strong journalistic voice with varied sentence rhythms: long analytical sentences contrast with short, punchy conclusions (“These are not soft skills.”). Direct address (“your,” “you”) maintains reader engagement throughout. The attributed quotation from Faridah adds authenticity and demonstrates the ability to use detail effectively. Memorable closing hook (“Your future self. . . is waiting for you there”). Consistent semi-formal tone.

Chapter 5 Format Quick-Reference Table

Use this table as a fast reference during revision to check the key formatting requirements for each text type.

Text Type	Salutation	Sign-off	Key Format Elements	Tone	Key Feature
Formal Letter	Dear Mr/Mrs [Name], or Dear Sir/Madam,	Yours sincerely (named) / Yours faithfully (unnamed)	Address · date · recipient address · subject line	Formal	Addresses match sign-off
Informal Letter	Dear [First Name], or Hi [Name],	Love, / Take care, / Best wishes,	Sender address · date	Informal	Friendly, personal
Email	Formal: Dear Mr/Mrs [Name], Informal: Hi [Name],	Formal: Regards, Informal: Cheers,	To · From · Date · Subject	Varies	Clear subject line
Report	None	None (ends with Conclusion)	Title · Prepared by · Submitted to · Date · Numbered headings	Formal, objective	Section headings
Speech	Good morning, teachers and fellow students.	Thank you.	Greeting · hook · call to action	Engaging, persuasive	Rhetorical devices
Proposal	None	None (ends with Conclusion)	Title · Prepared by · Submitted to · Date · Numbered headings	Formal, persuasive	Benefits + concerns
Article	None	None (memorable closing line)	Headline · byline · hook	Semi-formal	Catchy headline

Chapter 6 How to Elaborate Effectively

Elaboration is the single most important skill in Situational Writing. Simply listing or restating the content points will result in a low score. You must develop each point with relevant detail.

During planning (the “A” in RAWCP), jot down just one or two letters next to each content point to indicate your REED choice (e.g., “R + D” for Reason and Detail). This takes only seconds but guarantees that every point is properly elaborated.

6.1 The REED Technique

For each content point, use at least one of the following methods to elaborate:

NOTE: REED is one of several elaboration frameworks used in Singapore schools. The SEAB syllabus does not prescribe any specific elaboration method. Other common frameworks include 5W1H (Who, What, When, Where, Why, How) and PEEL (Point, Evidence, Explanation, Link). Use whichever method works best for you.

REED Elaboration Techniques

Code	Stands For	Explanation and Example
R	Reason	Explain <i>why</i> . E.g., “This event should be held in the school hall because it can comfortably accommodate all 500 students.”
E_x	Example	Give a specific instance. E.g., “Last year’s charity run, for instance, raised over \$3,000 for the Children’s Society.”
E_f	Effect	State the result or consequence. E.g., “This would improve student welfare and cultivate a more positive school environment.”
D	Detail	Add specific who/what/when/where/how. E.g., “The workshop will run from 2.00 p.m. to 4.00 p.m. on 15 March in the school library.”

You do not need to use all four for every content point. Using one or two methods per point is sufficient, but you must go beyond simply restating the point.

6.2 Model Body Paragraph Structure

Many students know what REED stands for but struggle to turn a content point into a well-developed paragraph. Use this five-sentence structure as a template:

Sentence	Function
Sentence 1	State the content point clearly, rephrased in your own words. Do not copy from the question.
Sentences 2–3	Apply your first REED element (e.g., Reason or Detail). Develop the point with specific information.
Sentences 4–5	Apply a second REED element (e.g., Effect or Example). This ensures the 2–3 sentences of elaboration required for Band 5.

Example using Content Point “Suggest an activity for the school carnival”:

Sentence 1: “I would like to suggest setting up a photo booth at the carnival.” (Content point restated)

Sentences 2–3: “Photo booths are particularly popular among students as they provide a memorable and interactive way to capture the occasion. Props such as themed hats, illustrated signs, and decorative frames could be prepared at minimal cost.” (Detail)

Sentences 4–5: “This activity would also encourage spontaneous social interaction among students from different classes, thereby strengthening the sense of community across year groups.” (Effect)

This five-sentence structure is a guide, not a rigid rule. Some content points may need only three sentences; others may need six. The key is that every content point receives at least two to three sentences of elaboration beyond the initial statement.

6.3 Weak vs. Strong Elaboration

Weak (Restating Only)	Strong (With Elaboration)
“I suggest we have a carnival. It will be fun.”	“I propose organising a school carnival, as it would provide students with a relaxed setting to bond with peers from other classes. Activities such as a themed photo booth and a local food stall would appeal to students across all year groups.”
“We should raise funds. We can sell things.”	“To raise funds, I recommend setting up a bake sale during recess, as home-baked goods are consistently popular and inexpensive to produce. Based on past events, such a sale could realistically generate between \$200 and \$300 per day.”

6.4 Paraphrasing the Visual Text

Copying information word for word from the visual text is penalised even when you identify the correct content points. You must convert stimulus details into your own words using one or more of these five techniques:

Technique	Visual Text Says	Your Paraphrase
Synonym substitution	“Participants will receive a free goodie bag.”	“Each participant will be given a complimentary gift pack.”
Sentence restructuring	“The event starts at 9 a.m. and ends at 12 p.m.”	“Running from 9 a.m. to 12 p.m., the event spans three hours.”
Active ↔ Passive switch	“The school will provide all equipment.”	“All necessary equipment will be supplied by the school.”
Combining details	“Venue: East Coast Park. Date: 15 April. Time: 8 a.m.”	“The event will take place at East Coast Park on 15 April, commencing at 8 a.m.”
5W1H amplification	“Activity: Beach clean-up”	“Volunteers will collect litter along the shoreline, working in groups of five with gloves and refuse bags provided, covering a designated 500-metre stretch.”

5W1H amplification (Who, What, When, Where, Why, How) is especially powerful for generating original elaboration when the visual text gives you only a brief fact. This turns a single line from the stimulus into two to three sentences of developed content.

Chapter 7 Language and Style Tips

7.1 Choosing the Right Register

Before writing, confirm that your level of formality matches the audience. A letter to a principal requires formal English. An email to a friend allows a conversational tone. Do not mix registers within the same piece.

Formal Register	Semi-Formal Register	Informal Register
Letters to authority figures Reports Proposals Formal speeches	Emails to teachers or adults you know Articles for school publications	Emails/letters to friends Personal journals
Use: “I would like to...”, “I wish to propose...”, “I am writing to...”	Use: “I hope you will consider...”, “I wanted to share...”	Use: “Hey!”, “Guess what?”, “You will not believe this!”

Register Markers Checklist

Formal Register Markers	Informal Register Markers
No contractions (“I am” not “I’m”)	Contractions expected (“I’m”, “you’ll”)
Formal alternatives to phrasal verbs (“enquire” not “ask about”; “request” not “want”)	Phrasal verbs acceptable (“find out”, “come up with”)
Full date format (15 March 2026)	Casual date references acceptable (“next Saturday”)
Formal connectors (“Furthermore”, “Consequently”, “In light of this”)	Informal connectors (“By the way”, “Anyway”, “Also”)
Passive voice where appropriate	Exclamatory sentences permitted
“Yours faithfully” / “Yours sincerely”	“Take care” / “See you soon” / “Best wishes”

Even in informal writing, avoid actual slang (“slay it”, “no cap”, “legit”). Examiners cannot accurately assess language ability through slang. Write naturally and warmly, but always in standard English.

7.2 Sentence Variety

Examiners reward varied sentence structures. Avoid writing only simple sentences. Use a mix of the following:

- **Simple:** “The event was a success.”
- **Compound:** “The event was a success, and many students expressed interest in participating again.”
- **Complex:** “Although attendance was lower than expected, the event was considered a success by the organising committee.”
- **Compound-complex:** “Although the session was voluntary, over 30 students attended, and several requested that it be made a regular feature of the school calendar.”

7.3 Useful Phrases by Purpose

Purpose	Useful Phrases
Requesting	“I would like to request...”; “I would be grateful if you could...”; “Would it be possible to...”
Suggesting	“I would like to suggest...”; “One possible approach is...”; “It might be worth considering...”
Persuading	“This would benefit...”; “It is important to note that...”; “Surely we can agree that...”
Complaining	“I am writing to express my concern about...”; “I was disappointed to find that...”; “This matter requires urgent attention.”
Thanking	“I would like to express my sincere gratitude for...”; “Thank you for taking the time to...”; “Your support has been invaluable.”
Giving Information	“I am writing to inform you that...”; “This report aims to outline...”; “The findings indicate that...”

7.4 Common Language Errors to Avoid

Incorrect	Correct
<i>“I am writing to informed you...”</i>	“I am writing to inform you...”
<i>“The students is excited...”</i>	“The students are excited...”
<i>“Irregardless of the situation...”</i>	“Regardless of the situation...”
<i>“I hope you will revert back to me.”</i>	“I hope you will reply at your earliest convenience.”
<i>“Please kindly consider...”</i>	“Please consider...” or “Kindly consider...” (not both)
<i>“I am looking forward to hear from you.”</i>	“I am looking forward to hearing from you.”

7.5 Varying Tone for Persuasion and Engagement

Different text types call for different levels of persuasive intensity. Choosing the right tone signals to the examiner that you understand your audience and purpose.

Text Type	Standard Phrasing	Elevated Phrasing
Speech	“This event is important because it helps the community.”	“It is our collective responsibility to give back to the community that has given us so much.”
Proposal	“This programme will be good for students.”	“This programme would equip students with essential life skills that extend well beyond the classroom.”
Formal Letter	“I hope you will think about my request.”	“I trust that you will give this request your careful and favourable consideration.”
Informal Letter	“You should try joining a CCA.”	“Joining a CCA was honestly the best decision I made in school — you will not regret it!”

In speeches and proposals, use inclusive language such as “we,” “our,” and “together” to create a sense of shared ownership. In formal letters, use measured and respectful language to demonstrate maturity.

7.6 Appropriate Use of Figurative Language

Figurative language, when used appropriately, can make your writing more vivid and engaging. However, it is only suitable for certain text types.

Device	Acceptable In	Avoid In
Metaphor: “The canteen is a war-zone during recess.”	Informal letters, speeches, articles	Reports, proposals, formal letters
Simile: “Joining a CCA is like discovering a second family.”	Informal letters, speeches, articles	Reports, proposals
Hyperbole: “I must have waited a thousand years in that queue!”	Informal letters only	Reports, proposals, formal letters, speeches
Rhetorical Question: “Is this not what our school stands for?”	Speeches, articles	Reports, formal letters

Using figurative language in a formal report or proposal makes your writing sound unprofessional. Reserve it for text types where a personal or emotive voice is expected.

7.7 The Power of Specificity

One of the simplest ways to elevate your Language score is to replace vague, general words with precise, concrete ones. Examiners reward writing that demonstrates a strong and deliberate vocabulary.

Vague and Weak	Precise and Strong
<i>“The council did the donation drive.”</i>	“The council spearheaded the donation drive.”
<i>“Many students came for the event.”</i>	“Over 200 students attended the event.”
<i>“The food was nice.”</i>	“The food was freshly prepared and warmly received by students.”
<i>“We want to make the school better.”</i>	“We aim to cultivate a more inclusive and supportive school environment.”
<i>“The event was good.”</i>	“The event was well-organised and achieved its intended objectives.”

Replace “did” with action verbs such as “spearheaded,” “organised,” “initiated,” or “coordinated.” Replace “good” and “nice” with precise adjectives such as “well-received,” “productive,” or “engaging.” These small substitutions have a noticeable impact on your Language mark.

Chapter 8 Exam Phrase Templates

The following ready-made templates can be adapted to fit almost any Situational Writing question. Memorise these structures and slot in the relevant details during the exam.

8.1 Opening Paragraph Templates

Situation	Template
Making a request	"I am writing to request [what you want] in relation to [topic/event]. As [your role], I believe this would [benefit/improve]..."
Making a complaint	"I am writing to express my concern regarding [issue]. On [date/occasion], I encountered [brief description of the problem], and I feel this matter warrants your prompt attention."
Making a suggestion	"I am writing to propose [idea/plan] for [purpose]. Having observed that [brief context], I believe this initiative would be of considerable value to [audience/community]."
Giving information	"I am writing to inform you about [topic/event]. As [your role], I would like to share the following details so that [purpose/reason]."
Thanking someone	"I am writing to express my sincere gratitude for [what they did]. Your [support/generosity/effort] during [event/situation] made a meaningful difference to [outcome]."
Inviting someone	"I am writing to extend a formal invitation to [event/activity], which will be held on [date] at [venue]. As [your role], I would be honoured to have you [participate/attend]."
Responding to a situation	"I am writing in response to [the announcement/the notice/your letter dated...]. I would like to [share my views/offer my support/raise several points] regarding this matter."

These opening templates work for both formal letters and formal emails. Simply adjust the format accordingly. The key phrase "I am writing to" signals your purpose clearly and immediately.

8.2 Closing Paragraph Templates

Situation	Template
After a request	"I hope you will give this request your favourable consideration. Should you require any further information, please do not hesitate to contact me. Thank you for your time."
After a complaint	"I trust that this matter will be looked into promptly. I look forward to receiving your response and a satisfactory resolution at your earliest convenience."
After a suggestion	"I am confident that this proposal will benefit [target group]. I would be happy to discuss this further and to assist with implementation if required."
After giving thanks	"Once again, thank you for your [kindness/generosity/support]. Your contribution has made a truly lasting impact, and we are deeply grateful."
After an invitation	"We sincerely hope you will be able to join us. Kindly confirm your attendance by [date]. We look forward to welcoming you at the event."
General formal close	"Thank you for taking the time to consider this matter. I look forward to your favourable response."

8.3 Linking and Transition Phrases

Use these phrases to connect your ideas smoothly between content points. Strong transitions demonstrate to the examiner that your response is well-organised.

Function	Phrases
Adding a point	"In addition,..."; "Furthermore,..."; "Moreover,..."; "Building on this,..."
Giving a reason	"This is because,..."; "The reason for this is,..."; "This can be attributed to..."
Giving an example	"For instance,..."; "For example,..."; "A case in point would be,..."; "To illustrate,..."
Showing contrast	"However,..."; "On the other hand,..."; "Nevertheless,..."; "Despite this,..."
Showing result	"As a result,..."; "Consequently,..."; "This would lead to,..."; "In light of this,..."
Emphasising	"It is important to note that,..."; "Significantly,..."; "Above all,..."; "Most importantly,..."
Concluding	"In conclusion,..."; "To sum up,..."; "All things considered,..."; "In light of the above,..."

Do not overuse transition phrases. One per paragraph is usually sufficient. Inserting a connector into every sentence makes your writing sound mechanical and rehearsed.

8.4 Elaboration Sentence Starters

These sentence starters help you develop your content points beyond a single statement. Pair each content point with one or two of these to build strong elaboration.

Elaboration Type	Sentence Starters
Explaining why	“This is important because...”; “The primary reason for this is...”; “This would help to ensure that...”
Providing details	“Specifically,...”; “In particular,...”; “This would involve...”; “The details are as follows:...”
Describing impact	“This would allow [group] to...”; “As a result, [group] would benefit from...”; “The outcome of this is...”
Making comparisons	“Compared to [alternative], this approach...”; “Unlike the previous arrangement,...”
Anticipating concerns	“While some may argue that..., I believe...”; “Although this may require..., the long-term benefits outweigh...”

8.5 Speech-Specific Phrases

Part of Speech	Phrases
Opening	“Good morning, teachers and fellow students. I stand before you today to...”; “Have you ever wondered why...?”; “Imagine a school where...”
Engaging the audience	“Ask yourselves this:...”; “I am sure many of you have experienced...”; “Let us consider for a moment...”
Building momentum	“Not only would this..., but it would also...”; “Together, we can...”; “If we act now, we will see...”
Closing	“Let us take this step forward together.”; “I urge each and every one of you to...”; “The choice is ours. Let us make it count. Thank you.”

For speeches, the rule of three is a powerful technique. Group ideas in threes for impact: “This event will build friendships, strengthen teamwork, and create lasting memories.”

8.6 Informal Letter and Email Phrases

Part of Message	Phrases
Opening	“Hey [Name]! How have you been?”; “It was so good to hear from you!”; “I hope this finds you well. I have some news to share!”
Sharing news	“Guess what?...”; “You will not believe what happened!”; “I have been meaning to tell you about...”
Giving advice	“If I were you, I would...”; “You might want to consider...”; “Here is what I would do:...”
Expressing feelings	“I was so relieved to hear that...”; “I completely understand how you feel.”; “That must have been really difficult for you.”
Closing	“Anyway, I have to go now. Write back soon!”; “Let me know what you think!”; “Take care and I will speak to you soon!”

Even in informal writing, you must still address all content points with elaboration. A friendly tone does not mean less content — it means the same content delivered in a relaxed manner.

Chapter 9 Final Exam Tips and Reminders

9.1 Time Triage: What to Do When You Are Running Out of Time

If you reach 200 words and realise you have only addressed part of the content points, do not panic. Apply the following triage rule:

All points briefly always scores higher than half the points in detail. The Task Fulfilment band descriptors gate Band 4 (7–8 marks) behind “all points addressed.” If you address only most points, you are capped at Band 3 (maximum 6 marks) regardless of how well you elaborate the points you did cover.

Situation	What to Do
Plenty of time, all points covered	Ideal scenario. Go back and add a second REED element to any under-developed content point. Proofread carefully.
Running low, 1–2 points remaining	Reduce elaboration to one sentence per remaining point. Address every point even if briefly. A short paragraph is better than a missing one.
Almost out of time, 3+ points remaining	Write a single paragraph that touches every remaining point in one or two sentences each. Sacrifice depth entirely but ensure every point is mentioned. Then close immediately.

9.2 Final Reminders

No.	Reminder
1	Always use the name given in the question. Never use your real name. If no name is provided, use a generic name such as “Alex” or “Sam.”
2	Never copy the content points word for word. Rephrase them and add your own elaboration. Lifting directly from the question signals a lack of language ability to the examiner.
3	Stay within the word count. The syllabus requires 250–350 words. In practice, aim for 300–320 words : this gives you enough space to elaborate every content point with REED (roughly 60–80 words per body paragraph) while staying comfortably inside the range. Going well below 250 words almost certainly means insufficient elaboration; going well above 350 wastes time you need for Continuous Writing, which carries equal marks.
4	Paragraph your response clearly. Each content point should generally occupy its own paragraph. A wall of text is difficult to read and signals poor organisation.
5	Match your tone to the audience throughout. Do not begin formally and then slip into casual language halfway through. Consistency is essential.
6	Do not invent content points. Address only what the question asks. Adding irrelevant information wastes time and does not earn additional marks.
7	Practise handwriting legibly. In the actual exam, illegible handwriting costs marks. Examiners cannot award marks for what they cannot read.
8	Use RAWCP, your text-type acronym, and REED. RAWCP for time management. Your text-type acronym (CHOPE IT / SHIOK / STAMP / TIKAM / KENA / BOLEH / CLICK) for format and structure. REED for elaboration. These three tools together address the most common weaknesses in student responses.

REMEMBER

Correct Format + All Content Points Addressed
 + Effective Elaboration + Accurate Language = Top Band